



Progress of Phase 1 in Ram Van Gaman Path

Chief Minister of Chhattisgarh, Mr. Bhupesh Baghel, launched the first phase of the ambitious Ram Van Gaman Tourism Circuit on 7 October 2021 in Chandkhuri, the birthplace of Mata Kaushalya. The State Government has allocated approximately Rs. 139 Crore for this multi-phased project. On 8 April 2022, a three-day-long grand inaugural event was held in Shivrinarayan to mark the completion of the Shivrinarayan temple development work under the Ram Van Gaman project. Till now, the state government has identified 75 spots that Lord Ram had traversed during his years in exile. Under the first phase of this project 9 places have been marked for infrastructure development, restoration, and beautification. They are Sitamarhi-Harchauka (Koriya), Ramgarh (Sarguja), Chandkhuri (Raipur), Rajim (Gariyaband), Shivrinarayan (Janjgir-Champa), Turturiya (Balodabazar), Sihawa Saptarshi Ashram (Dhamtari), Jagdalpur (Bastar), and Ramaram (Sukma). Among the various places that Lord Ram had visited includes Shivrinarayan, Sitamarhi Harchauka, Raigarh, Bastar, Rajim, etc. and the last destination was the village Ramaram in the Sukma

mention as the maternal home of Shri Ram whose mother, Mata Kaushalya, was born in Chandkhuri, a town close to Raipur. However, the most tangible bond between the Suryavanshi prince from Ayodhya and Chhattisgarh is the fact that he spent about 10 years of the 14 years of his exile in the dense forests of the state, travelling to 75 places, which the State Government wants to develop as religious tourism sites. It is also said that the ashram of the great sage Valmiki, who composed the Ramayana is located in Turturiya village, Balodabazar district. Additionally, it was this hermitage where Mata Sita had taken shelter when she had been banished from Ayodhya and where she gave birth to the twins Luv and Kush.

Retracing Footsteps of Lord Ram in Chhattisgarh

The significance and impact of Lord Ram is marked on Chhattisgarh's history and culture where he is worshipped and cherished as the epitome of righteousness. To highlight the legacy of Lord Ram, where he spent a crucial part of his exile, the Chhattisgarh Government conceptualised the idea of developing the Ram Van Gaman Tourism Circuit to acquaint future generations with the traditions and relics of the Ramayana era in the state, take pride in them, and to encourage them to preserve, protect and showcase their culture.

The Ram Van Gaman Tourism Circuit aims to retrace the sacred footsteps of Lord Ram in Chhattisgarh by developing all the places that he had travelled along with his consort Mata Sita and brother Laxman, during his arduous exile into tourism spots. The Ram Van Gaman Path will, therefore, pay a worthy tribute to the important era in Treta Yuga when Lord Ram set a glorious example of righteousness by obeying his father King Dashrath's command and leaving the palace in Ayodhya, to lead a gruelling life wandering

in the forests.

"The aim of Ram Van Gaman tourism circuit is to preserve the memories linked to Lord Ram's stay in the state during his exile from Ayodhya. When it comes to places of religious significance, Chhattisgarh has a long list to offer to tourists," CM Baghel is reported to have said.

